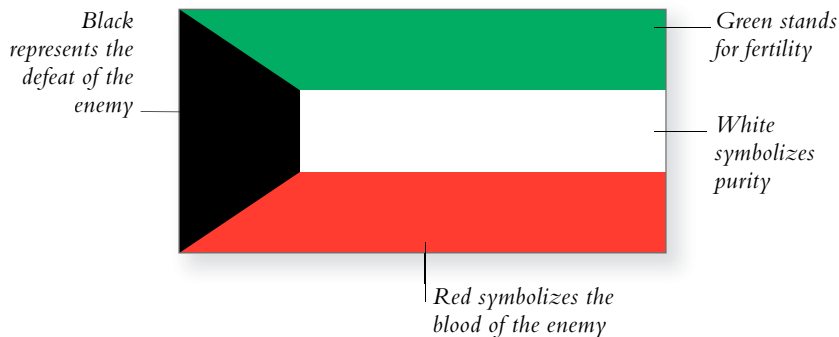


Kuwait

Ratio: 1:2 **Adopted:** September 7, 1961 **Usage:** National and Civil



Asia



The State of **Kuwait** traces its independence to 1710, but it was under British rule from the late 18th century until 1961.

Before 1961, the flag of Kuwait, like those of other Gulf states, was red and white. The present flag is in the pan-Arab colors, but each color is also significant in its own right. Black symbolizes the defeat of the enemy, while red is the color of blood on the Kuwaiti swords. White symbolizes purity and green is for the fertile

land. The idea for the flag's distinctive design—a horizontal tricolor with a black trapezium in the hoist—may have come from the flag used by Iraq until the late 1950s.

KUWAIT'S COAT OF ARMS

The arms depicts a hawk containing an Arab *dhow* on stylized waves.

ARMS OF KUWAIT

